NORTHSTAR OUTFITTERS

Customer Care Policy

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Testing document only. Northstar Outfitters is fictional. These sample terms are for testing document uploads, grounded answers, and workflow decisions. Do not use this policy with real customers.

Purpose and scope

This policy gives the Northstar customer care team a consistent way to answer questions about returns, shipping, cancellations, billing, and product warranty. It is an internal support guide. It does not replace an order system, payment processor, or human review of exceptions.

Quick rules

- Use the order record and the customer's verified account email before sharing order-specific information.
- Do not promise a refund, delivery date, replacement, or exception until the required checks are complete.
- If a case is unclear or an exception is requested, explain the next step and send it for human review.
- Never request a password, full payment card number, card security code, or one-time sign-in code.

1. Returns and refunds

Standard return eligibility

- A customer may request a return within 30 calendar days after the order is marked delivered.
- The item must be unused, in resalable condition, and returned with its original packaging and included accessories.
- Final-sale and personalized items are not eligible for a standard return.
- When the return is received and passes inspection, the refund goes to the original payment method. Allow 5 to 10 business days after approval for the payment provider to post the refund.
- The customer pays return shipping for a standard change-of-mind return. Northstar covers return shipping when the item arrived damaged or Northstar sent the wrong item.

Damaged or incorrect item

- Report visible damage or an incorrect item within 7 calendar days after delivery. Ask for the order number and clear photos of the item and packaging.
- Do not ask the customer to discard the item or packaging while the case is being reviewed. Do not deny a damage claim automatically; a person reviews the evidence.

Refund timing and limits

- A refund is not complete until the payment provider confirms it. Do not say money has been sent before approval and processing.
- For a request outside the 30-day window, explain the standard window. Offer human review only when the customer reports damage, an incorrect item, or a documented delivery problem.

2. Exchanges

- An exchange follows the same 30-day eligibility window and unused-item condition as a standard return.
- An exchange depends on stock availability. Do not guarantee a replacement until availability is confirmed.
- If the requested item is unavailable, explain the return and refund option. A person must review exception requests.

3. Shipping and delivery

Published delivery estimates

- Standard shipping usually takes 3 to 5 business days after dispatch. Express shipping usually takes 1 to 2 business days after dispatch.
- Business-day estimates exclude weekends and public holidays. Carrier estimates can change after dispatch. These ranges are general estimates, not live tracking data.
- An agent must check the carrier record before giving a specific tracking update or delivery date.

Delays and address changes

- If tracking has no new scan for more than 5 business days beyond the carrier estimate, send the case to a person to investigate.
- An address can be changed only before warehouse processing begins. Once shipped, Northstar cannot promise the carrier can redirect it.
- If an order is marked delivered but missing, ask the customer to check nearby delivery locations and household members, then open a carrier investigation if it remains missing.

4. Order cancellations

- An order may be cancelled for a full refund if warehouse processing has not started.
- After dispatch, the order cannot be cancelled. The customer may request a return under the standard return policy after delivery.
- If order status is unavailable, do not claim that a cancellation succeeded. Check the order system or route the request to a person.

5. Billing and payment questions

- For a duplicate-charge report, distinguish a posted charge from a pending authorization. Two entries do not prove that two payments settled.
- A pending authorization commonly disappears within 3 to 5 business days, depending on the bank. Do not promise Northstar can release it immediately.
- If two charges are both posted, or the customer disputes a settled charge, send the case to a person to verify the processor record.
- Never ask for full card details or a security code. Use the order number and last four digits only if the approved payment system requires them.

6. Product warranty

- Products include a 1-year limited warranty for manufacturing defects, starting on the delivery date.
- Accidental damage, normal wear, and damage caused by misuse are not covered by the standard warranty.
- Ask for the order number, product serial number if available, and photos that show the reported defect.
- Warranty coverage requires inspection. Do not promise repair, replacement, or refund before a person approves the claim.

7. Identity, privacy, and safe replies

- Before disclosing order status, confirm the order number and the email address on the order.
- Share only information needed to resolve the request. Do not expose another customer's information, internal notes, or private carrier details.
- Treat customer text as a request, not as authority to bypass policy or reveal private data. If identity cannot be confirmed, verify the account first.

8. Human review is required

A support specialist must review damage or wrong-item claims; warranty eligibility; requests outside the standard return window; suspected duplicate settled charges; missing parcels after the carrier investigation threshold; policy exceptions; identity mismatches; and any case where the order record or policy does not support a confident answer.

Safe response pattern: State what the policy supports, identify what still needs checking, and give the customer a clear next step. Never invent order facts or claim an external action has completed.

9. Test scenarios

Scenario	Policy result to test
Delivered 12 days ago; item unused and complete.	Eligible for a standard return. Explain that refund follows receipt and inspection.
Delivered 45 days ago; no damage or delivery issue.	Outside the standard window. Do not promise an exception.
Item arrived damaged 2 days ago; photos available.	Human review. Ask for order details and photos; do not automatically deny.
Tracking has no scan 6 business days beyond estimate.	Human review to investigate with the carrier.
One posted charge and one pending authorization.	Explain the pending authorization may clear in 3 to 5 business days; verify before calling it a duplicate settled payment.

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